



b. 1941 · Swedish businessman, former CEO of Scandinavian Airlines (SAS).

"15 seconds decides the whole relationship."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Carlzon believed that a service business is built or destroyed in the brief frontline encounters customers actually remember, not in the boardroom or the org chart.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

As CEO of a struggling SAS in the early 1980s, he reoriented the airline around the customer-facing 'moments of truth', decentralising authority to frontline staff.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors Moments of Truth in Unit 1, the lens that concentrates customer-experience investment on the decisive few interactions.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

His approach operationalises as empowering frontline employees to act in the customer's interest at the moment of contact, supported rather than constrained by management.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

The idea can underweight the back-stage systems and culture that make good frontline moments possible; moments of truth are necessary but not sufficient.

ENDURING IMPACT

'Moments of truth' entered the standard vocabulary of service management and customer experience, later extended by Procter & Gamble and Google.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 1)

Russell Ackoff · Giant 1

John Boyd · Giant 2

Clayton Christensen · Giant 3

W. Chan Kim & R. Mauborgne · Giant 5

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Carlzon, J. (1987) Moments of Truth. Cambridge: Ballinger.

Normann, R. (1984) Service Management. Chichester: Wiley.